

Eric Ries

The Lean Startup & Build–Measure–Learn

b. 1978 · Entrepreneur & author · originator of the Lean Startup method



1 WHY THIS THINKER MATTERS

Ries turned prototyping into a scientific discipline. His build–measure–learn loop and the MVP are why Unit 8 treats a prototype as an experiment, not a draft — the fastest way to find out whether anyone wants what you are building.

2 INTELLECTUAL FOUNDATION

American entrepreneur and author. Building on Steve Blank's customer development and lean manufacturing, he articulated the Lean Startup: a method for developing products under extreme uncertainty through validated learning.

"The only way to win is to learn faster than anyone else."

"As you consider building your own minimum viable product, let this simple rule suffice: remove any feature that does not contribute to the learning you seek."

3 FRAMEWORKS · TOOLS · MODELS

NAME	WHAT IT IS
The Lean Startup	Manage innovation under uncertainty via validated learning
Build–Measure–Learn	The core iterative feedback loop
Minimum Viable Product	Smallest build that generates learning
Validated learning	Evidence of real progress, not vanity metrics
Pivot or persevere	Data-driven decision to change or continue

4 HOW IT'S OPERATIONALIZED

- Frame the riskiest assumption as a testable hypothesis
- Build the MVP needed to test it, no more
- Measure real behaviour, not vanity metrics
- Decide to pivot or persevere on evidence
- Shorten the build–measure–learn loop relentlessly

5 LIMITATIONS & CRITIQUES

- MVP framing can excuse shipping poor quality
- Metrics focus may crowd out vision and design
- Less suited to deep-tech or long-cycle products
- 'Lean' sometimes applied dogmatically
- Under-weights brand, ethics and second-order effects

6 ENDURING IMPACT

- *The Lean Startup* a global movement and bestseller
- MVP and pivot now standard startup vocabulary
- Reshaped how corporates run innovation units
- Embedded experimentation in product development
- Direct anchor for BCOBM126 Unit 8 prototyping

SELECTED WORKS

THE LEAN STARTUP <i>How Today's Entrepreneurs Use Continuous Innovation</i> RIES · 2011	THE STARTUP WAY <i>How Modern Companies Use Entrepreneurial Management</i> RIES · 2017	THE LEAN STARTUP (contrib.) <i>Crown Business</i> RIES · 2011	BUILD-MEASURE-LEARN <i>Lean toolkit</i> RIES · 2011
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REFERENCES (HARVARD · CITE THEM RIGHT)

- Ries, E. (2011) *The Lean Startup*. New York: Crown Business.
- Ries, E. (2017) *The Startup Way*. New York: Currency.